Pantawagas "Tao" Biston

H. Farouk/Pantawagas Maruhom Anggol Capalan Biston (rahimahullah; June 16, 1932 – November 23, 2010) was a Filipino educator and public servant from Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur, best remembered for a public service career built on quiet discipline and an untarnished reputation. A Dansalan College scholar and honor student who studied Political Science at Silliman University before pursuing law at the University of Manila, he taught at LNCAT (now MSU LNCAT), managed government finances at the Philippine Pilgrimage Authority and the Bureau of Internal Revenue, served as OIC Mayor of his hometown, and later lent his expertise as a consultant to Governor Zacaria Candao, the first Governor of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM). To this day, he is remembered as the patriarch of the Biston family and as a man whose name, in his own words, was never allowed to be tarnished.

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Early Life

Pantawagas Biston was born on June 16, 1932, in Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur. He would go on to become one of the town's most respected sons, a quiet man whose life eventually became a kind of blueprint for how to live with integrity in public service.

Education

Biston pursued his college education at Silliman University in Dumaguete City, where he took up AB Political Science as a Dansalan College (DC) Scholar, a distinction he earned for being an honor student. He later moved on to study law at the University of Manila, though he did not complete his law degree, choosing instead to carry his political science training and disciplined mindset directly into teaching and public service.

Pantawagas "Tao" Biston



Born

June 16, 1932
Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur, Philippines

Died

November 23, 2010 (aged 78)

Other Names

H. Farouk Pantawagas Maruhom Anggol Capalan Biston; also known as "Tao"

Education

AB Political Science, Silliman University (Dansalan College Scholar, Honor Student)
Bachelor of Law studies, University of Manila (undergraduate, did not finish)

Occupation

Educator, Government Finance Officer, Public Servant, Government Consultant

Notable Positions

Professor, LNCAT (now MSU LNCAT)
Chief, Director, and Fiscal Comptroller, Finance Division, Philippine Pilgrimage Authority (PHILPA)
Chief Revenue Officer, Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR)
OIC Mayor, Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur
Consultant to Gov. Zacaria Candao, first

Career

A Teacher Who Pushed for Greatness

Long before he entered public office, Biston was already shaping young minds as a professor and teacher at LNCAT, the institution now known as MSU LNCAT. He was known around campus for holding his students to incredibly rigorous standards. Former students still tell stories of him tossing chalk or erasers across the room just to snap a distracted classmate back to attention, a habit that became something of a legend among those who sat in his class.

Underneath that strict exterior, though, was a mentor who genuinely cared about pushing every young person in front of him toward their full potential. It says something about the kind of teacher he was that several of his former students went on to become well-known names in their own right.

Governor of the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM)

Spouse / Family

Patriarch of the Biston family

Notability

Regarded as a model of incorruptible public service in Lanao del Sur, having managed government funds across several agencies without a single stain on his name.

Known For

His decades-long career spanning education and government finance, and the family principle he lived by: "Do not tarnish my name."

A Lifetime of Trusted Leadership

Biston's commitment to public development eventually carried him into vital financial and government roles. He served as Chief, Director, and Fiscal Comptroller of the Finance Division for the Philippine Pilgrimage Authority (PHILPA), an agency that operated under Secretary Lininding Pangandaman at the time. PHILPA has since evolved into today's Bureau of Pilgrimage and Endowment under the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF), continuing the same mission of protecting the rights and welfare of Muslim Filipinos.

From there, he brought his financial expertise to the Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR), where he served as a Chief Revenue Officer. He performed so well in that role that he was already being lined up for a promotion to Regional Director. But duty called him back home instead: then Governor Saidamen Balt Pangarungan appointed him OIC Mayor of Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur, the very town where he was born and raised.

A Trusted Voice in the New ARMM

Biston's reputation for sound judgment and financial discipline followed him well into the region's political development. When the Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) was established, he was tapped as a consultant by its first Governor, Zacaria Candao. It was a fitting role for a man who had already spent decades helping build trustworthy institutions across Muslim Mindanao, and it placed him right at the center of one of the most significant political milestones in the region's history.

Character and Legacy

By nature, Biston was a quiet, reserved man who rarely offered an opinion unless asked. He preferred to let his everyday actions speak louder than his words ever could. Across the region, he was known for his generosity and his readiness to help anyone who needed it, regardless of who they were. Those who knew him say that in his entire lifetime, no one could point to a single bad word about his character.

Handling public funds across so many financial and government posts is the kind of responsibility that tests anybody's integrity, but Biston held himself to an uncompromising standard throughout. He never once engaged in corruption, cheating, or misuse of public resources. Instead, he lived and governed by a simple principle that he impressed deeply upon his children: "Do not tarnish my name."

He carried that principle all the way to his final days on November 23, 2010, leaving behind a name that remains entirely untarnished and a memory that continues to inspire the Biston family and the community of Bacolod-Kalawi.

See Also

- Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur
- Mindanao State University
- Silliman University
- National Commission on Muslim Filipinos
- Bureau of Internal Revenue (Philippines)
- Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Zacaria Candao

References

- Family accounts of the Biston family provided by **Hosnie Marmay Biston** (https://www.facebook.com/hosnie.biston)
- Accounts from former colleagues and students
- Public service records, Bureau of Internal Revenue and Philippine Pilgrimage Authority
- Local government records, Bacolod-Kalawi, Lanao del Sur
- ARMM records under Gov. Zacaria Candao

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